Pattern detectives at practice

How Rhythm Is Math

Name _____ Date _____

Write one number in each blank, then explain the step you found.

1. Little’s clap counts grow by 2 each time. Which count comes next?

1, 3, 5, 7, ___

Show your thinking.

2. Big marks every other count in a repeating rhythm. Which count is missing?

2, ___, 6, 8

Show your thinking.

3. A stack of beat cards grows by 5 each time. Which total comes next?

5, 10, 15, 20, ___

Show your thinking.

Pattern detectives at practice

How Rhythm Is Math

Name _____ Date _____

Write one number in each blank, then explain the step you found.

4. Little counts pattern cards in steps of 5. Which total is missing?

10, 15, ___, 25

Show your thinking.

5. Practice taps are counted in steps of 10. Which total comes next?

10, 20, 30, 40, ___

Show your thinking.

6. Big counts all the claps from several rounds in steps of 10. Which total is missing?

20, ___, 40, 50

Show your thinking.

A beat nearby

A drum sounded through the wall. Little felt a heartbeat too. It was steady-ish, not a perfect clock, but it offered a clue.

A tick to count

Big tapped evenly while Little counted. Each number landed on a steady beat. Counting helped them stay together.

Four make a bar

In 4/4 time, one bar has four beats. A louder ONE can show where the group begins again.

Steady steps

Four beats felt balanced, like left-right-left-right. The sounds changed, but the quiet count stayed steady underneath.

Pattern detectives

Rhythm uses sounds and silences across a beat. A rest is counted silence, not a lost beat. Patterns can repeat.

Teach your rhythm

Little filled four boxes with CLAP, pat, or rest, played the row, and taught the pattern to Big.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

WONDER DAILY

How Rhythm Is Math

Write a rhythm someone can follow

How Rhythm Is Math · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose a scene. Say your pattern first, then draw or write it.



A tick to count



Patterns to repeat



Teach your rhythm

Draw four boxes. Fill each box with CLAP, pat, or rest.

beat · rhythm · pattern · count · group · bar · rest · repeat · steady · loud

ONE, two, three, four feels … dictate a feeling word

My pattern is … say CLAP, pat, or rest four times

To teach it, I will … tell how someone can follow your beat

Does your pattern have four places? Read or dictate each place in order.

How Rhythm Is Math

01 What makes a beat feel steady?



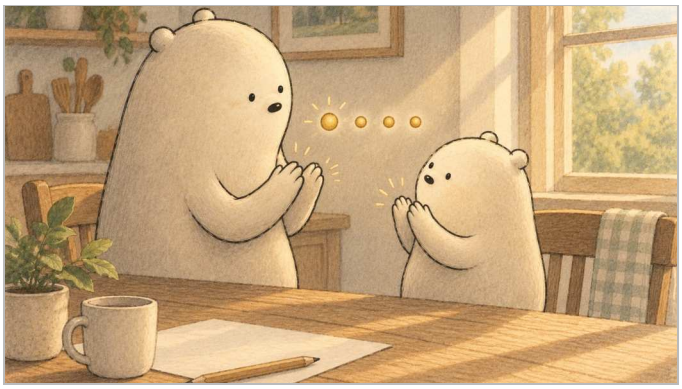
A faraway drum and a heartbeat offer two gentle clues about pulse.

Look closer. Find Little listening to the drum and feeling the gentle pulse in their chest.

A little explanation. A beat is the steady pulse underneath a rhythm. A heartbeat can remind us what a pulse feels like, although a real heart speeds up and slows down. It is steady-ish, not a perfect metronome.

Try this. Put a hand on your chest for a quiet moment. Then tap a table at your own comfortable, even speed.

02 Why does ONE help us find our place?



An even count gives every clap a place to land.

Look closer. Watch Big and Little clap while four small beat marks repeat nearby.

A little explanation. Musicians group beats so they can find their place. In 4/4 time, each bar has four beats: ONE, two, three, four. A stronger ONE can mark the start of the next group. Many songs use four, but not every song does.

Try this. Clap four even beats. Make ONE a little louder, then repeat the group.

03 Can silence belong inside a rhythm?



A sound can land on ONE while the steady count continues.

Look closer. One piano key glows on ONE while the other counted beats stay quiet.

A little explanation. Yes. A rest is a counted place of silence. The beat keeps moving underneath it. Sound on counts one, two, and four with silence on three still makes a four-beat rhythm.

Try this. Clap one, clap two, stay silent on three, and clap four. Keep your counting steady.

04 How can four boxes hold a rhythm?



Four boxes make a small pattern that can sound, pause, and repeat.

Look closer. Each box on the beat card holds one clap or one rest symbol.

A little explanation. Rhythm is a pattern of sounds and silences across a beat. It can use long and short sounds, claps and rests, then repeat. Musicians are pattern detectives: they count, group, notice, and repeat.

Try this. Draw four boxes. Put CLAP or REST in each one, play the row, and teach it to someone.